



Holy Family Parish

A praying, caring community, centred in Christ

Holy Family Parish is a member of a Family of Parishes, comprising the parishes of St Patrick’s, Holy Family and St Gerard’s.

MASS SCHEDULE

SUNDAYS

Holy Family Church: 6pm Vigil & 10.30am

St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: 9am & 12noon

WEEKDAYS

Holy Family Church: 9.15am Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday

St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: 10.00am Thursday, Friday & Saturday

SACRAMENT OF RECONCILIATION

Holy Family Church: Saturday 5.15pm-5.45pm

St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: Saturday after 10am Mass

BAPTISMS

(Prior booking via Parish Office)

Holy Family Church: Saturdays at 4pm

St Thérèse of Lisieux Church: Sundays at 1pm

DEVOTIONS

Eucharistic Adoration: Daily 10am-10pm (St Thérèse)

Pilgrim Prayer: Tuesday 8pm on the Parish Facebook page

Novena to Our Mother of Perpetual Help: Wed 9:15am Mass

First Saturday: 10am (Holy Family)

Taizé Prayer: last Friday of the month 8-9pm (Holy Family)

SAINTS OF THE WEEK

Sun 23:	St Eugene (St Eoghan)
Mon 24:	St Bartholomew, Apostle
Thu 27:	St Monica
Fri 28:	St Augustine
Sat 29:	The Beheading of St John the Baptist

St Monica, speaking about her death: *“Lay this body anywhere; let not the care for it trouble you at all. This only I ask; that you remember me at the Lord’s altar, wherever you may be.”*



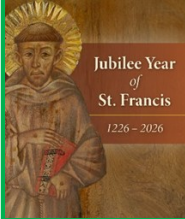
CONTACT INFORMATION

Parish Clergy: Very Rev. Michael Spence PP,
Rev. John O’Lavery CC & Rev. Deacon Brendan Dowd

Parish Telephone (Office hours): 90743119
Office hours: Mon-Thu 9.30am-2.30pm, Fri 9.30am-1.30pm
Address: 226-228 Limestone Road, Belfast BT15 3AP

Emergency Sick Calls only (24hrs): 07928968773
Society of St Vincent de Paul (Helpline): 028 90351561

Email: holyfamily@downandconnor.org
Website & Webcam: www.holy-familyparish.com



21ST SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

23RD AUGUST 2026

Readings: A (II) Psalter: Week I



THE OLD PAROCHIAL HOUSE AT ST THÉRÈSE CHURCH

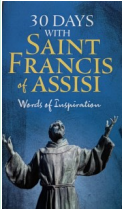
At Masses on the weekend of 28th June, parishioners were informed that a group called Dom Polski had expressed an interest in acquiring the old presbytery. This group is keen to establish a Polish Cultural Hub for their community in Belfast.

As a way to officially launch this project, a garden party has been organised by Dom Polski for Sunday 30th August 2026, 4pm—6pm, in the grounds of St Thérèse church. There is an open invitation to all parishioners and neighbours. Full details below.



JUBILEE YEAR OF SAINT FRANCIS

“Jesus is happy to come with us, as truth is happy to be spoken, as life to be lived, as light to be lit, as love to be loved, as joy to be given, as peace to be spread” (St Francis)



A Prayer Resource

30 DAYS WITH ST FRANCIS OF ASSISI. To mark this anniversary year, and to prepare for the feast day of St Francis’ on 04th October, this booklet is available from the parish office, price £3. Using the words of St Francis himself, it offers Scripture and short prayers. This simple resource can help us to reflect on the wisdom of St Francis, for today.

PARISH NEWS & EVENTS

WEEKLY OFFERING. The weekly collection on Sunday 16th August came to £2,353.67, and the collection for the Diocesan Cathedral Fund was £1,355.28, with an additional £315 in standing order donations. Thank you for your continued generosity and support. For information on standing order and contactless methods of donation, please contact the parish office.

PARISH 100 CLUB. Week 15 winners: Mrs Ashmore, Anne Cassidy, Niall McKeefry & Angela Mullin (Promoter). Congratulations to all the winners.

LOUGH DERG. Visit www.loughderg.com, for details of events during August & September, incl. one day retreats, Heritage Day tours, and the Lakeshore Pilgrim Path Pilgrimage.



HOLY FAMILY BEREAVEMENT MINISTRY, (formally known as Bethany), is a voluntary parish-based service offering support to the bereaved, no matter when a loved one died. Our Bereavement Ministers offer a listening ear at any stage of the grieving process. If you would like the support of our Bereavement Ministry team, please contact the parish office, to arrange.



CONGRATULATIONS to the young people of our parish, on your recent exam achievements. May the Holy Spirit guide you in your choices for the future.

Back to school Prayer

Dear Lord, as our students begin a new school year, we pray that you will keep them in your care. Send your Spirit to open their minds to all that is true, beautiful and good. Help them to see the gifts and talents you have given them, and to use them well. Help them to grow in knowledge and wisdom. Help them be kind to others, and lead others to be kind to them. Give their teachers patience and understanding, and help them teach what is just and true. Send your angels to guide and guard our children, and to keep them from all harm. Open their young hearts to your presence, and enfold them in your peace and protection. Hold them in the palm of your hand, and bring them home safely at day’s end. Amen.



REST IN PEACE

Recently Deceased: Bertha Tracey, Mary Jamieson, Kieran O’Mahony OSA

Month’s Mind: Bernadette Lenny

Anniversaries: Fr Jim McWilliams, Alice O’Kane, Tommy John O’Kane, Ita Rooney, Maureen Hession, Tom Downey, Patrick McDermott, Mick McAleer, Bernice Shirazi (née Deery), Aleykutty Joseph, Mona Conlan, Margaret Walsh, Bernie McCormack, Gerard Rea, Mary Rea,

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord!

For more information and resources:
www.holy-familyparish.com

MASS INTENTIONS

Sat 22 (6pm):	Patrick McDermott
Sun 23 (9am):	Tom Downey
Sun 23 (10.30am):	For the People of the Parish
Sun 23 (12 Noon):	Bernadette Lenny MM
Mon 24 :	Margaret Walsh
Tue 25:	Aleykutty Joseph
Wed 26:	For someone who is recently deceased
Thu 27:	Priest’s Intention
Fri 28:	Priest’s Intention
Sat 29 (10am):	Priest’s Intention

